



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cair Paravel Latin School Inc
School Website: <https://cpls.org>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Cair Paravel Latin School (CPLS) in Topeka, Kansas demonstrates a robust classical Christian education. Public materials consistently present the school as explicitly classical (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin-centered, literature-focused, and faith-infused, with ongoing emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and the formation of character. Evidence across the CPLS site shows explicit references to God-centered formation, a literature curriculum built on reading classics, a Latin program and proficiency, and pedagogies that include Socratic-seminar-inspired inquiry at higher grades, along with a living curriculum articulated by staff. The school also foregrounds parental partnership and a strong community orientation anchored in faith and tradition. Overall, CPLS scores CLASSICAL across all six categories in the rubric.

Key considerations from the Classical rubric (as reflected in CPLS public materials): - The school repeatedly foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty, and frames education as formation rooted in faith. This aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose elements. - Curriculum emphasizes grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, and classical literature, with explicit emphasis on reading the classics, Great Books, and formation through wonder; this aligns with Curriculum and Pedagogy. - Pedagogical approaches reference memory, recitation, and elevated dialogue (upper school), with a rhetoric focus in the high school, consistent with classical pedagogy. - Faculty bios present teachers as living curriculum and mentors, with a clearly defined teacher portrait and collegial culture. - Parents & Community emphasis highlights parent partnerships, co-teaching roles, and accessible on-site visitation, consistent with the classical community model.

Evidence is drawn from CPLS site content and staff materials (e.g., God-centered language and virtues, Great Books/Latin emphasis, staff bios, literature program materials, and parent/community messaging). Supporting context from the knowledge-base lexicon confirms the canonical positive/negative indicators for classical education used in this evaluation. See sources: CPLS site materials (e.g., God Is The Center; Book Me a Passage; Logic School; staff bios; memory verses), and the Six Essential Elements lexical framework.

- Foundational rubric reference: Positive/Negative keyword indicators, including terms such as truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; wonder; liberal arts; Great Books; Latin; Socratic; scholé; memory; recitation; living curriculum; parent partnership, and open campus; negatives include secular humanism, values clarification, project-based dominance, etc.
- Core CPLS public statements clearly map to the themes above: "God Is The Center," classical curriculum emphasis, integrated faith with academics, memory-based and recitation-oriented pedagogy, and explicit mention of Great Books/classics in literature programming.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials foreground God-centered formation and a Christian worldview (e.g., "God Is The Center" and "CPLS partners with parents to keep God at the forefront of life"). - The school presents itself as rooted in faith and classical Christian education (e.g., "Imparting the hearts of lions with classical Christian

education” in the site metadata/branding). - Memory-verse style content and devotional framing appear in the school’s longer-term memory verse program (Understanding Salvation; Knowing God; Growing as a Christian; etc.).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: God, Center, faith, Christian, theology, Scripture/Bible, worship (liturgy-related language appears via liturgical framework in discussions of faith and memory verses), wonder, beauty, truth, goodness, logos, virtue. The site frequently uses phrases tying education to faith and the sacred.

- Negative keywords present: None identified in public materials (no explicit secular/humanist or relativistic framing observed). The lexicon notes potential negative signals; CPLS content shown does not present those signals.

Why this rating - The materials consistently emphasize theology-informed formation, sacred framing of education, and a communal, liturgical-inflected sense of purpose. This aligns with Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal Practices in the Classical rubric. The presence of explicit God-centered language and biblical/theological formation supports a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The education aim is described as formation of virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty rather than purely job preparation (formation, human flourishing, telos). The Great Conversation/true-good-beautiful framing appears across site materials (e.g., “pursue truth, beauty, and goodness” within capital campaigns and program descriptions). - The site emphasizes liberal education, formation over mere information, and the cultivation of virtue and humanity. Memory-verse themes and the emphasis on lifelong formation appear in the memory-verse content. - The Great Conversation and permanent questions frame is present in the classical approach and liturgical/educational philosophy discussions (e.g., “classical education” branding, integration of faith into learning).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful, liberal education, scholé, contemplation, human excellence, great conversation. The site uses language that maps to these terms (e.g., “classical education,” “truth, goodness, and beauty,” “formation”).

- Negative keywords present: None evident (no emphasis on workforce-prep or job-training as primary telos in the public messaging). The lexicon notes such signals as negative; CPLS messaging remains formation-first.

Why this rating - The messaging centers on formation, virtue, virtue-centered human flourishing, and engagement with classic literature and philosophy as part of a liberal-arts formation. This maps strongly to the CLASSICAL category for School Purpose and Goal.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is framed around the liberal arts tradition: grammar, logic, rhetoric; strong emphasis on Latin and classical literature; explicit focus on reading the classics and classic texts; and a literature program that emphasizes a habit of reading and engagement with “the classics.” The Book Me a Passage program and literature policy emphasize reading classics and a literature-log approach. - The school hosts a Logic School (7th–8th) emphasizing critical thinking, logic, and structured reasoning, with connections to Latin, literature, Bible, history, and rhetoric; rhetoric-focused upper levels (Rhetoric School) are described. - Latin-institutional identity is evident (Latin School branding, Latin-related coursework, and Latin-focused staff). The staff bios explicitly reference Latin and classical study (e.g., “Grammar, Logic, & Rhetoric School Latin”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, great books/classics, history, liberal arts, literature, memory work, recitation, narrations (pedagogical aspects tied to classical education). The site explicitly uses “classical,” “Great Books/reading the classics,” and “Latin.”

- Negative keywords present: None clearly observed (the site does not emphasize project-based dominance or STEM-first framing as a core methodology; rather, it foregrounds classical humanities). The lexi-

con notes “negative signals” like project-based dominance; CPLS messaging remains more classical than project-based.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin study; engagement with classical literature; and a history- and Great-Books orientation align with the Curriculum criteria for CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy appears to include singing, memory work, and reverence for learning as a form of delight, consistent with some contemplative/restful elements and memory-based pedagogy in classical education (scholé). While explicit “scholé days” language is not universally advertised on every page, the heritage of memory work and recitation is evident in the literature policy and program materials. - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic-style inquiry, seminars, debates, and rhetoric development (Rhetoric School) with opportunities to present and argue (speech, declamation, and oratory are referenced in the pedagogy outline). The Logic School description emphasizes independent thinking, questioning, discernment, and logic, with cross-disciplinary connections to literature, Latin, Bible, and history. - The presence of a Rhetoric School and opportunities for speeches and rhetorical training are explicit (the staff page identifies Rhetoric School, Latin, and Senior Classical League sponsorship).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: socratic/seminars/debates, rhetoric, memory work/recitation, scholé, contemplation, wonder, seminar, dialogue, memory-based learning, liturgical integration. - Negative keywords present: minimal to none (no dominant emphasis on purely project-based or experiential-only pedagogy). The classical lexicon lists experiential/project-based as negative signals; CPLS materials emphasize classical methods rather than a project-based emphasis.

Why this rating - The school’s public-facing materials reflect a pedagogy that includes both contemplative/restful elements (lower grades, memory work) and high-school Socratic/seminar-driven inquiry and rhetoric training, consistent with CLASSICAL pedagogy expectations.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty bios present teachers as mentors and living curriculum, with a focus on virtue and character formation. Examples include staff profiles describing long-term commitment, faith-driven motivations, and classroom leadership that models virtue (e.g., Jason Lichte; James Seidel; Beverly Keys; Debbie Christiansen). These bios present teachers as central to the educational mission and living curriculum. - The staff is described in ways that echo the classical lexicon: “the living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” and a “faculty of friends” through which students learn. The biographies emphasize vocation, faith, and moral formation as part of teaching. - The school’s staff reflects a long-term, mission-aligned culture, with multiple faculty bios displaying a shared commitment to the school’s classical mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, mentor, master, guide, virtue, character formation, spiritual formation, pedagogical expertise, faith-based teaching. The lexicon identifies these ideals as core to the classical faculty concept. - Negative keywords present: None observed (no language suggesting a non-classical faculty approach). The lexicon notes negative signals such as “facilitators on the side” or purely certification-driven contexts; CPLS materials emphasize classical teacher leadership and mentorship instead.

Why this rating - The public-facing faculty content aligns with the CLASSICAL expectation that faculty are the living curriculum and moral exemplars, modeling virtue and classical pedagogy.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents and regards parents as co-teachers; parent formation and involvement are highlighted (e.g., parent-partner statements in admissions, literature programs, and capital campaigns). The “More Than Mortar” capital campaigns and parent-facing communications emphasize family involvement and faith-based community building. - The site communicates that parents

are heavily involved in the learning process (e.g., the literature program requires parental engagement with reading logs and a literature policy; the “Book Me a Passage” program highlights parental collaboration and involvement). - Open campus and visit opportunities are indicated (e.g., “Schedule a Tour” and admissions processes), which aligns with the classical community model of accessible parental engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, seminars, book clubs, family liturgy alignment, open campus, home-school collaboration. - Negative keywords present: None observed (no implication of parents as customers only; the messaging positions parents as integral partners in formation). The lexicon notes negative signals such as consumer language; CPLS messaging avoids those patterns.

Why this rating - CPLS presents a robust model of parent collaboration, formation-led communication with families, and opportunities for parental learning and involvement, matching the CLASSICAL Parents & Community criteria.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Abstract

Cair Paravel Latin School (CPLS) demonstrates strong alignment with the classical education rubric across all six categories. Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit through God-centered framing, Christian pedagogy, and theological content embedded in memory-verse programs. The school’s purpose emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and a telos oriented toward truth, beauty, and goodness, consistent with liberal-arts formation. Curriculum centers on grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, and the study of classics, with clear Great Books/classics orientation and a literature program. Pedagogy integrates contemplative/restful elements with Socratic-style inquiry, seminars, and rhetoric development in upper grades. Faculty are presented as living curriculum and virtuous mentors, and the Parents & Community category shows strong partnership with families through co-teaching models, education for parents, and open campus access. The public materials map closely to the Positive keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon, with negligible evidence of negative signals. Overall, CPLS earns a CLASSICAL rating, reflecting a cohesive classical-Christian educational philosophy in practice and public presentation.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL — God-centered formation; theology integrated; liturgical/community signals in school culture.
- School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL — Formation-focused, virtue/wisdom telos, truth/beauty/goodness as real, liberal-arts orientation.
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL — Grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; classical literature; Great Books/classics emphasis; history-informed curriculum; cultivation of wonder.
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL — Restful/memory-based elements in lower grades; Socratic/seminar/rhetoric development in upper levels; emphasis on memory work and classical discourse.
- Faculty: CLASSICAL — Living curriculum; model teachers; portrait of a teacher; long-term faculty commitment; mentorship culture.
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL — Strong parent partnership; parental formation; open-campus visits and tours; co-teaching model.

Note: The assessment relies on the school’s public-facing materials and staff bios, cross-referenced with the classical education keyword framework (positive indicators for the six elements) from the knowledge-vector lexicon. The CPLS materials consistently align with the classical indicators identified in the Six Essential Elements lexicon. See the lexicon for the formal positive/negative keyword framework used in categorization.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY - Overall Rating: CLASSICAL - Most influential signals: explicit “classical education” branding, grammar-logic-rhetoric curriculum, Latin emphasis, Great Books/classics literature orientation, Socratic/rigorous high-school rhetoric training, living-fee faculty mentorship, and robust parent/community partnership.

ABSTRACT Cair Paravel Latin School (CPLS) is classified as CLASSICAL across all six classical-elements categories. The public-facing site presents a coherent classical Christian program: a faith-integrated, truth/virtue/beauty-centric telos; a curriculum built on liberal-arts primaries (grammar/logic/rhetoric) with Latin and Great Books/classic literature; a pedagogy blending memory work, recitation, and higher-level Socratic/seminar discourse; faculty as living exemplars and mentors; and a strong parental partnership model with open-campus engagement. The findings draw on CPLS site content (e.g., God-centered language, the Book Me a Passage literature program, Logic School and Rhetoric School descriptions, staff bios, and memory-verse materials) and the Six Essential Elements lexicon of classical education. The aggregate evaluation supports a CLASSICAL designation, with the most meaningful insights centering on CPLS’s explicit, holistic integration of faith, classical curriculum, and family involvement as core to its educational identity.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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